

Digital Modernisation at Linklaters LLP

Leading a secure, scalable, and collaborative transformation of the firm's digital ecosystem Executive snapshot

I led the Digital Modernisation Programme at Linklaters LLP, a global law firm operating across 30+ jurisdictions.

At a glance

The programme modernised infrastructure, applications, and user experience to enable secure, scalable, and collaborative operations across the enterprise.

Role: Programme Manager, leading delivery across infrastructure, applications, and service management.

Headline impact: A modern, secure, and scalable digital platform, with improved collaboration and mobility, enhanced cybersecurity and compliance, streamlined IT operations and service delivery, and a foundation for future innovation and digital growth.

Challenge and context

Linklaters LLP operates across 30+ jurisdictions, creating a global environment in which digital services must support secure, scalable, and collaborative work across the enterprise.

The starting point was a technology landscape that needed modernisation across infrastructure, applications, and user experience. Legacy systems, the need for stronger cybersecurity and compliance, and the demand for more connected ways of working established the case for a coordinated programme rather than isolated technology changes.

The challenge was to align the firm's technology landscape with its strategic vision for digital excellence and operational agility while improving service delivery across business functions.

Programme objectives

The programme translated that context into five connected objectives:

- **Modernise the platform** — Replace legacy systems with modern, cloud-based platforms.
- **Enable global collaboration** — Enhance collaboration and mobility for global teams.
- **Strengthen protection** — Strengthen cybersecurity and compliance posture.
- **Optimise operations** — Optimise IT operations through automation and integration. **Improve experience**
- — Improve user experience and service delivery across business functions.

Together, these objectives formed a single transformation agenda spanning technology, security, operations, and the user experience.

Solution and delivery approach

I led a multi-tower Digital Modernisation Programme that brought infrastructure, application, and service-management transformation together under a unified governance framework.

The delivery approach combined a multi-phase roadmap with cross-functional ownership, migration and integration of critical business systems, modern service-management practices, and structured controls for change, release, and risk. This created a coordinated path from technology modernisation through to operational adoption.

The approach balanced enterprise-scale change with the practical needs of global teams: modernising the underlying environment, improving collaboration, strengthening protection and compliance, and making IT services more consistent and effective.

Core delivery streams

The programme was organised around five connected delivery streams:

Delivery stream	Focus
Infrastructure modernisation	Cloud and network optimisation, with a focus on performance and resilience.

Digital workplace transformation	Microsoft 365 and collaboration to strengthen productivity and connectivity.
Application rationalisation	Legacy applications and integration, supporting reduced technical debt.
Cyber security enhancement	Identity and data protection, compliance, and risk management.
Service management optimisation	ITSM and automation to support efficiency and service quality.

Programme execution and governance

As Programme Manager, I defined and governed a multi-phase delivery roadmap and coordinated cross-functional teams across infrastructure, applications, and operations.

Key execution activities

- Defined and governed the multi-phase delivery roadmap.
- Managed cross-functional teams across infrastructure, applications, and operations.
- Delivered migration and integration of critical business systems.
- Established new service-management processes aligned to ITIL v4.
- Oversaw vendor coordination and assurance across multiple suppliers.
- Implemented structured change, release, and risk-management frameworks.

Governance was maintained through PMO oversight, steering-committee reporting, and executive stakeholder engagement. This provided the visibility and control needed to coordinate delivery across technical and business domains.

Technology highlights

The technology work translated the programme's objectives into a modern, integrated operating environment:

Area	Delivery highlight
Cloud migration	Transitioned core workloads to Microsoft Azure and hybrid environments.

Identity modernisation	Implemented Azure AD, MFA, and conditional access policies.
Collaboration platform	Rolled out Microsoft Teams and SharePoint for global document management.
Automation	Introduced ServiceNow workflows for incident, request, and change management.
Security uplift	Integrated vulnerability management and compliance dashboards.
Data integration	Unified reporting and analytics across business systems.

Stakeholder engagement

I coordinated across a broad stakeholder landscape:

- Global IT leadership and business sponsors.
- Infrastructure, application, and security teams.
- External vendors and managed-service providers. Regional offices
- and user-adoption leads.

Through structured communication and transparent governance, the programme achieved alignment across technical and business domains. Engagement connected global IT leadership and business sponsors with delivery teams, suppliers, regional offices, and useradoption leads.

Outcomes and impact

The programme delivered a modern, secure, and scalable digital platform. Its impact was reflected in five qualitative outcomes:

Outcome	Impact
Digital platform	A modern, secure, and scalable foundation for the firm.
Collaboration and mobility	Improved collaboration and mobility across global offices.

Cybersecurity and compliance	Enhanced cybersecurity and compliance posture.
IT operations and service delivery	Streamlined IT operations and service delivery.
Future readiness	Established a foundation for future innovation and digital growth.

These outcomes capture the programme's value without overstating it: the transformation strengthened the firm's digital foundation and improved how technology supported global operations.

Strategic contribution

The Digital Modernisation Programme positioned Linklaters LLP as a digitally enabled, globally connected law firm.

By modernising infrastructure, applications, and service operations, the firm achieved greater agility, resilience, and user satisfaction. The programme also set a benchmark for digital transformation within the legal sector and created a platform for future innovation and digital growth.

Strategic value

The programme connected technology renewal with operational agility, secure collaboration, and a stronger foundation for the firm's future.

Key takeaways

The programme demonstrates several lessons that apply to complex digital transformations:

- **Integrate the agenda.** Bring infrastructure, applications, service management, security, and user experience into one coordinated programme.
- **Govern for alignment.** Use PMO oversight, steering-committee reporting, and executive engagement to connect technical delivery with business priorities.
- **Design for secure collaboration.** Treat identity, access, compliance, mobility, and collaboration as connected parts of the digital workplace.
- **Make operations part of transformation.** Pair migration and integration with ITIL v4aligned service management, automation, and structured change, release, and risk frameworks.
- **Build for what comes next.** A modern, scalable platform should create a foundation for future innovation and digital growth.